Note

The different generations of the economic reforms in India should not be seen as the completion/ending of the former and commencement of the later generations of the reform. Basically, all of the Generations are going on at present simultaneously, so that the goal of reforming the economy is objectified. The various generations of reforms in India also verify the fact that ‘reform’ is a continuous process which needs ‘fine-tuning’ in accordance with the changed situations. Reform is not the aim of the economy but reforming the economy is the aim. Reform is a means to an end.

We saw a general decline in the government’s eagerness towards furthering the cause of economic reforms once the UPA came to power in 2004 – largely due to the nature of the coalition which included the Left Front supporting it from outside (outside support is considered the weakest and the most delicate thing for a government by the world political thinkers and analysts). The returning of the UPA to power in 2009, with a bit different coalition partners could not ensue any new pace regarding furthering the reform process. Almost everyone, including the major industrial houses remarked the policy-paralysis of the government as the cause of hurting the pace of growth in the economy. The government document[38], *Economic Survey 2011-12*, says that though it is hard to quantify and for that reason is contestable, there has been seen a slackening in the pace of reforms – one consequence of increased awareness of high-profile corruption scandals in different parts of India and welcome civil-society activism has been a sense of caution among civil servants in taking crucial decisions. Since one way to avoid the charge of an ill-considered or, worse, bad-intentioned decision is to take no decision, it is arguable that some civil servants have resorted to precisely this strategy, concludes the Survey. This would cause a slowdown in decision making. In addition, coalition politics and federal considerations played their role in holding up economic reforms on several fronts, ranging from diesel and LPG pricing and taxation reform like the goods and services tax (GST) and direct taxes code (DTC), to FDI in retail and reform of the APMC Act, says the document.